

Weak Two-bids

Open 2♦, 2♥ or 2♠ with a 6-card suit headed by some honors and fewer 4-9 HCP.

Response of a new suit is not forcing. (Note: some pairs play this 1-round force)

Raise of Opener's suit is to play.

Response of 2NT is forcing and asks for further information.

After 2NT Response, Opener bids:

- 3 of original suit to show a weak hand

- 3 of another suit to show a good hand with high card in that suit

- 3NT with a suit of A K Q x x x

Preemptive Bids

An opening bid of 3 of any suit shows a 7-card suit and less than opening hand.

This is primarily a defensive bid, and you should be mindful of vulnerability, being more cautious when you are Vulnerable against Non-Vulnerable opponents. For these Deals assume neither side is Vulnerable.

As a rule of thumb, Responder should assume Opener can win six tricks and bid accordingly.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦4

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3♥

Declarer: East

Lead: ♠A

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: South

Lead: ♣6

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: West

Lead: ♦Q

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 3
♥ A Q 10 6
♦ K J 10 7
♣ 10 9 3

♠ A K 8 7 6 2

♥ 8 3

♦ 8 3

♣ K 6 5



♠ J 5 4
♥ K 9 4 2
♦ Q 5 4 2
♣ 8 7

♠ Q 9

♥ J 7 5

♦ A 9 6

♣ A Q J 4 2

NORTH's hand has the look of a Weak Two-bid, but it is one point too strong. So she opens 1 ♠.

SOUTH naturally bids 2 ♣ and NORTH rebids the ♠ suit.

SOUTH always knew there would be a game bid, so with an 8-card fit he bids 4 ♠

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♣
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			
Lead: ♦ 4			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J 8 3

♥ 10 6

♦ K J 4

♣ K Q J 4

♠ 10 7 4 2

♥ K 2

♦ Q 3 2

♣ A 10 8 7

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 6 5

♥ A Q J 8 7 5 3

♦ 9 7 5

♣ 5

♠ A K 9

♥ 9 4

♦ A 10 8 6

♣ 9 6 3 2

WEST may have an opening hand, but it is just the wrong kind of hand to respond to partner's preemptive bid. She doesn't have the immediate winners that EAST is likely to need, but she is in good shape for defense should the opponents bid.

In other words, WEST has the perfect hand with which to pass.

*West**North**East**South*

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by East

Lead: ♠ A

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 6
 ♥ Q 10 9 2
 ♦ 10 5
 ♣ Q 10 7 6 3

♠ 5 4

♥ 8 6 3

♦ A K Q 9 7 4

♣ 8 5



♠ 10 9 8 7 3 2

♥ J 5 4

♦ 8 2

♣ J 9

♠ K Q J

♥ A K 7

♦ J 6 3

♣ A K 4 2

West	North	East	South
	2♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by South			
Lead: ♣6			

The 2NT response to a Weak Two opening is a wonderful tool. You can learn a lot about partner's hand and you are absolutely certain that it will not be passed out.

In this Deal SOUTH has a huge hand and NORTH opens 2♦. There are a lot of approaches SOUTH might try, but the simplest is to start with 2NT.

When NORTH shows ♦ A K Q x x x SOUTH has an easy 6NT bid.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q 9 7 5 2

♥ K 3

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 7 3

♠ 10 4

♥ 10 8 5

♦ Q J 3

♣ J 9 8 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K J 6

♥ A Q J 4 2

♦ 9 6 4

♣ A 5

♠ 8 3

♥ 9 7 6

♦ A K 10 7

♣ K Q 10 2

West

2 ♠

3 ♥

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

Lead: ♦ Q

North

Pass

Pass

East

2NT

4 ♠

South

Pass

EAST is unsure whether to bid game or not. So she temporizes with 2NT.

WEST shows an above average hand plus a high card in ♥s.

EAST is no longer unsure, so she bids 4 ♠.